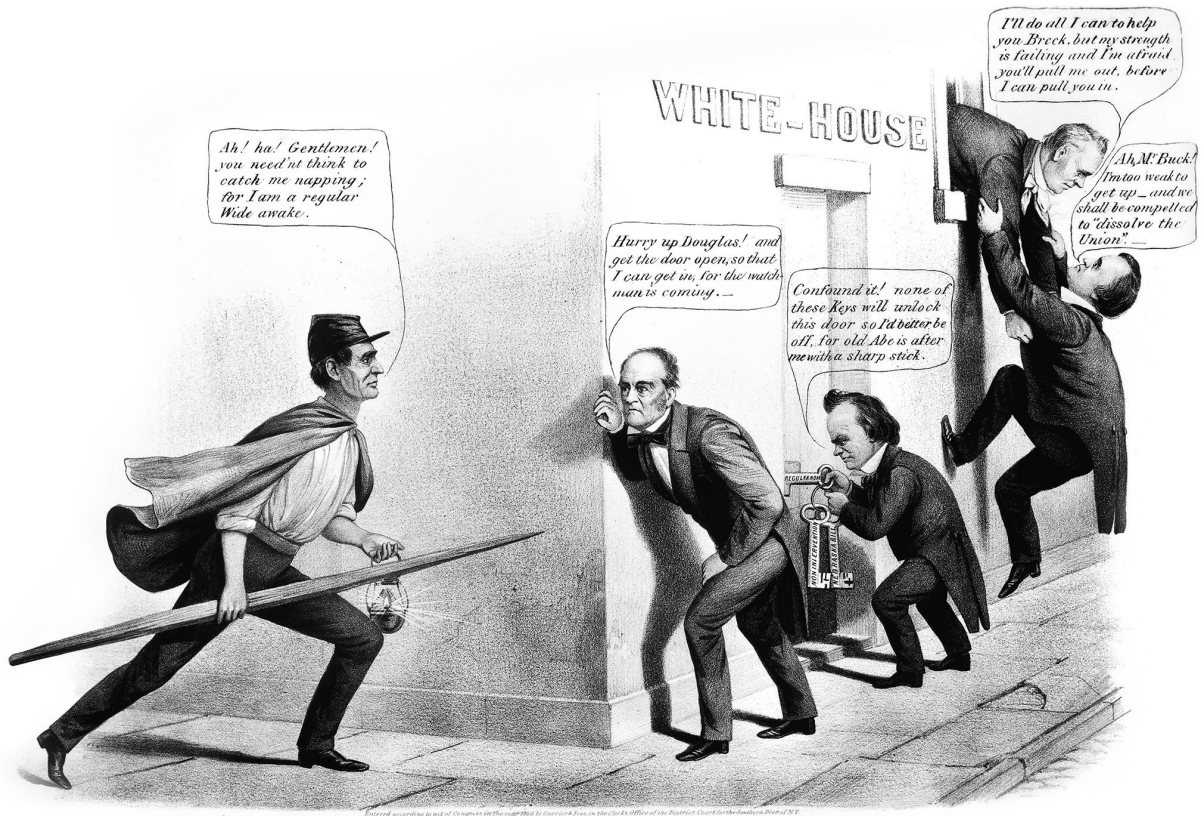




A four-way contest

Lincoln, the watchman, foils the efforts of the three other candidates trying to break into the White House—Breckinridge is hauled up to a window by President James Buchanan; Bell is lookout as Douglas unlocks a door.

Lincoln, Bell, and Douglas

In mid-May, the Republicans gathered in Chicago in a newly built convention center—dubbed the Wigwam—that could hold 12,000. Promising not to threaten slavery in the South, the Republican candidates repeated their opposition to its spread into the West. They also pledged free homesteads for westward-bound settlers and tariffs to protect Northern industry.

Recognizing the need for a moderate candidate who would be able to carry Pennsylvania and the Midwestern states, Republican delegates selected Abraham Lincoln on the third ballot. Lincoln was not an abolitionist, but he articulated the sentiment of a growing number of Northerners who saw slavery as the gravest threat to the Union and the future greatness of the nation.